



## What do startups think about the drones sector in India?

**Ankit Mehta, co-founder & CEO, ideaForge:** My expectation is that the drone manufacturing industry will jump to over ₹300 crore in a year, from around ₹60 crore today, and will subsequently be much bigger over the coming years.



**Prem Kumar Vislavath, Founder & CEO, Marut Drones:** The drone industry in India will be more like the IT industry, where we will have a huge base of engineers, developers, design firms, manufacturing firms working inside the drone ecosystem.

**Vikram Singh Meena, CEO & Founder, TechEagle Innovations Pvt Ltd:** The drone industry will grow 5x plus during the next 12 months.

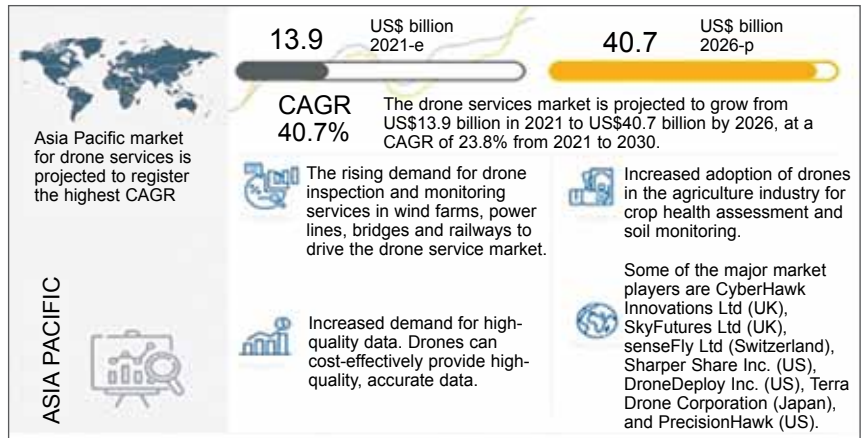


**Mrinal Pai, Co-founder, Skylark Drones:** The drone sector will become an opportunity for creation in India and providing it to the rest of the world. The opening of the sector coupled with the PLI scheme will open the door for tremendous growth and opportunities.

**Govind Balakrishna Raju, Founder CEO, 10Infinite:** The drone sector would grow just like the IT sector that grew and still continues to grow in India.



bought 30% stake in Turkish drone manufacturer Zyrone Dynamics Havacilik Danismanlik. The duo plans to work towards marketing drones in India and the rest of the world. It was also in the same month that RattanIndia Enterprises had announced investment in Mat-ternet. The latter is known as the world's most extensive urban drone



Attractive growth opportunities in drone services market

logistics platform.

However, to make sure that this PLI for drones is successful in not only enabling a local ecosystem of drone manufacturing in India but also in making India the go-to destination for drone manufacturing, service providers, drone component manufacturers, and startups, we will have to be on the same page. The easiest way to do so for the larger companies is to rely on startups for sourcing software and components. And for the SMEs, MSMEs, and startups, the key to success lies in crafting products that do not just appeal to India but to drone companies outside the borders of the country as well.

Dynamatics is setting an example by collaborating with Indian startups in terms of developing and sourcing critical components like sensors, communication systems, and more. Along with Adani group it has already started welcoming startups who wish to work with them.

"The opportunities are present equally in all the verticals of drones, be it components, system integration, data analytics, or services. The intent of the government is very clear, the drone sector is of strategic importance and the government wants to make India the global hub of manufacturing drones," feels Neel.

Sparsh Securitech, credited for

making CCTVs in India, is thinking of getting into manufacturing camera technology for drones. It is of the view that the segment is a quite promising one, especially for camera and imagery solution providers. A drone that is not enabled with vision (cameras) is quite difficult to even imagine. The global drone camera market, which was valued at \$3.33 billion in 2019, is projected by Allied Market Research to reach \$25.39 billion by 2027, registering a CAGR of 29.9%. Asia Pacific, once again, is projected to exhibit the highest CAGR of 31.3% during 2020-27.

"Cameras for drones are the key components that enable photos and video feeds via drones. We believe what was done for CCTVs in 2008, we can do the same for drone camera manufacturing in the coming years," says Sanjeev.

The point to be noted, in terms of components like cameras, communication systems, radars and more, is the opportunity that would arise from the anti-drone sector. This, in addition to the drone sector, also spells chances to cash-in for companies on both the drone as well as anti-drone systems. **EFY**

*This article has been prepared by Mukul Yudhveer Singh, Business Editor, Electronics For You, based on a panel discussion held during the Drone World Event in October 2021 on Tech World Congress platform.*